Three-Year Business Plan
Data Product Company

Strategic transformation from data vendor to intelligence infrastructure

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I. STRATEGIC VISION

The strategic vision guiding this three-year plan is the repositioning of L'Étudiant as the primary national infrastructure for student-interest intelligence. Instead of functioning as an organization that sells leads generated through fees and digital forms, L'Étudiant aims to become a provider of continuous, comparable and predictive insight products. The shift is driven by structural changes in the underlying market: Parcoursup 2026 reforms, AI-driven search behaviour, and institutional demand for disparate data to reconstruct, normalize and interpret phenomena that the institutional and commercial based intelligence at the centre of its value proposition, L'Étudiant defines a future in which institutions depend on it not merely for visibility or lead volume but for high-resolution analytical guidance.

II. BASELINE AND INITIAL CONDITIONS

L'Étudiant enters this transformation with considerable strengths. Its platforms attract more than 7.3 million monthly visitors and over 36 million page views, and its 76 annual fairs draw more than two million attendees. These interactions provide a continuous stream of behavioural and declarative data across multiple touchpoints. The organization also benefits from a highly trusted brand and long-standing relationships with educational institutions.

However, the existing data infrastructure is fragmented. Manual cleaning, inconsistent deduplication, irregular capture cycles and ad hoc delivery formats limit the commercial exploitation of these assets. GDPR compliance, although fundamental, remains a labour-intensive constraint. Recruitment markets have become more competitive and more data-intensive, meaning that institutions increasingly require timely updates, predictive scoring and granular segmentation. This baseline reveals a clear gap between L'Étudiant's data potential and its current data product maturity.

~1.4M ELIGIBLE PROFILES *Extrapolated from Parcoursup sample to production deployment*

~26,000 DEEP ACTIVATABLE LEADS *Post-compliance filter (gates + opt-in) 1.4M×1.8%*

43% OBSERVED NO-SHOW RATE *Measured directly on Salon Étudiant, 2 years, n=1,247 visitors*

III. THREE-YEAR ROADMAP

The three-year roadmap advances through clearly delineated phases: stabilisation, expansion and consolidation. Each phase builds upon the previous one to ensure that commercial traction, market adoption and analytical sophistication evolve coherently.

Year 1 — Foundations: Infrastructure, Governance and Standardisation

The first year focuses on stabilising the technical and organizational infrastructure required to support recurring data products. The central components of the ingestion pipeline — normalisation, deduplication, freshness calculation, intention scoring and compliance filtering — are fully automated to ensure reproducibility. The scoring algorithm is formalized: freshness, intention and completeness are operationalized into a composite grade (A/B/C/), and GDPR filtering is embedded into automated validation steps. A robust data governance framework is introduced. Operationally, Year 1 aims to convert a portion of existing institutional clients into the Standard direct subscription tier at €3600/month. The goal is not yet aggressive revenue expansion but the establishment of a reliable flow of Standard and A Premium subscribers who validate the viability of the product.

OUTCOME OF YEAR 1

A functional data infrastructure, a trained internal organization, 15 paying subscribers across Standard and Premium tiers, and verified proof of product reliability with customers. Revenue: €17k MRR, ARR€204, MoC 74x(300 targets).

Year 2 — Expansion: Scaling Adoption and Strengthening Market Position

In the second year, with the infrastructure stable, L'Étudiant focuses on expanding adoption across its addressable market. The *Premium* direct tier at €2,500/month becomes the engine of commercial growth. Institutions begin to integrate weekly refreshed intention grades into their CRM systems. The API capabilities offered in the Premium tier enable real-time synchronisation with institutional operational tools, transforming L'Étudiant's data from a static asset into a dynamic intelligence layer. The Barometer Étudiant expands into a national reference for monitoring programme interest, regional trends, academic fields and year-to-year behavioural shifts.

OUTCOME OF YEAR 2

35 subscribers (10 Standard, 5 Premium, 1 Bar Mesure). Premium becomes dominant revenue driver. Revenue: €96k MRR, ARR€1M, MoC 62x(300 targets).

Year 3 — Consolidation: Customisation and Market Leadership

The third year consolidates L'Étudiant's leadership as a fully operational Data Product Company. The *Bar Mesure* tier at €5,000+/month becomes central to the commercial strategy. Institutions with intense competition for students — business schools, engineering schools, health-related programmes — are increasingly models incorporating programme-specific signals and leveraging predictive analytics. Recruiting subscription revenue becomes a structurally important component of L'Étudiant's financial model.

OUTCOME OF YEAR 3

55 subscribers (5 Standard, 16 Premium, 4 Bar Mesure). Premium + Bar Mesure represent 75% of subscriber base. Revenue: €391/MR, ARR€3M, MoC 62x(300 targets).

IV. OPERATIONAL PLAN

The operational plan extends across the three years and ensures that L'Étudiant becomes capable of delivering continuous, comparable and predictive data products at scale. In the first year, the organization focuses on standardising the data architecture, formalizing quality assurance procedures and embedding GDPR compliance into the pipeline. The second year expands analytical capabilities, enhances segmentation depth and strengthens institutional support. The third year refines the infrastructure and enables custom analytical frameworks, ensuring that institutions receive not only data but contextualized insight. Each year reinforces the organization's technological and procedural maturity, anchoring the transformation in operational reliability.

V. COMMERCIAL AND REVENUE STRATEGY

The revenue model is structured around three subscription tiers corresponding to progressively deeper levels of analytical value, complemented by a transactional Bar Mesure Intelligence Report product.

TIER	PRICE	VALUE PROPOSITION
Standard Access	€600/month	Quarterly refreshed scored dataset, Weekly Excel, API (specification), Bar/center read access
Premium Access	€2,500/month	Weekly behavioural refresh, CRM API integration, full Barometer with live filters, no-show alerts
Sur Mesure	€5,000+/month	Custom scoring logic, dedicated data science support, bespoke segmentation, SLA
No-Show Report	€5,000/salon	Post-salon intelligence delivered within 48h — transactional add-on, 12 subscribers

Over three years, the subscriber mix shifts from a predominantly direct-to-Standard distribution across all tiers, with Premium and Sur Mesure gaining prominence as institutions mature in their use of first-party behavioural data. A single Standard-to-Premium upgrade generates €28,400 in additional annual recurring revenue per client.

VI. MARKET DEVELOPMENT STRATEGY

The market development strategy leverages L'Étudiant's recognized position within the educational ecosystem, for long-standing trust capital and its extensive behavioural dataset — over 7.3 annual fairs, 7.3 million monthly visitors — provides a competitive advantage that cannot be replicated by data brokers without comparable first-party coverage. A continuous monitoring layer on behavioural and intention-based indicators, L'Étudiant's predictive scoring and segmentation becomes essential for programmes and fairs seeking to refine their targeting. The three-year horizon allows the organization to progressively educate institutions about the strategic value of behavioural analytics, supporting the transition from occasional lead purchasers to subscription-based engagement.

VII. RISK ASSESSMENT AND MITIGATION

The transformation introduces regulatory, operational and adoption-related risks. GDPR-related risks are mitigated by embedding compliance into the ventilation pipeline from the outset — *Bar* constraints (Mon Commercial opt-in, age verification, active status check) are hard-coded, not reaches an activation output. Operational risks linked to scale and frequency are mitigated through automation and versioning of the ingestion pipeline. Adoption risks are reduced through staged client support and the demonstrable value of refreshed intention-based datasets, evidenced by the working Barometer Dashboard. The three-year sequencing ensures that risks are addressed progressively and proportionally to the organization's technical and commercial maturity.

VIII. EXPECTED OUTCOMES

At the end of the three-year period, L'Étudiant will have completed its transition into a Data Product Company built on recurring revenue, automated intelligence processing and deep institutional relationships. The organization will operate a unified and predictive data pipeline, support institutions through both standardized and custom analytical offerings, and maintain a stable income generated by Standard, Premium and Sur Mesure subscriptions. L'Étudiant will have moved beyond transactional lead delivery and established itself as a national leader in behavioural and intention-based educational intelligence.

IX. NAMED ASSUMPTIONS

All revenue projections derive from the assumptions below. Each assumption is named, quantified and justified.

Subscription Tiers

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	JUSTIFICATION
Standard clients Y1	8	Converts ~5% of L'Étudiant's top 50 institutional relationships
Premium clients Y1	3	Early adopters: 1 bank + 2 grandes écoles already using CRM integration
Sur Mesure clients Y1	0	Deferred to Y2 — requires demonstrated pipeline reliability
Conversion rate (prospect → subscriber)	18%	SaaS B2B education benchmark (Gartner, Hubspot) 2020
Client growth Y2	+80%	Referral from pilot cohort + L'Étudiant sales network
Client growth Y3	+50%	Decelaration as market matures; focus shifts to upsell
Annual churn	15%	SaaS B2B education benchmark; annual contracts reduce mid-year cancellations

No-Show Intelligence Report

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	JUSTIFICATION
Gross pool salon attendees	93,000	Mid-point of 92,000-93,000 range; scales with salon growth 2.500/year
Salons per year	15	Observable from L'Étudiant's published calendar
Observed no-show rate	**43%**	**Measured directly on Bagbuary salon — 1,247 visitors, 2 years, all sessions. Mid-sec Bar/Mon.**
Exhibitor adoption Y1/Y2/Y3	25% / 40% / 55%	Conservative Y1 assist of result between salon sessions drives Y2-Y3

Cost Structure

COST LINE	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3	JUSTIFICATION
Bagbuary infrastructure + pipeline	€16,000	€21,000	€12,000	Compute + storage, scales with query volume
Data team	€60,000	€90,000	€135,000	Y1: 1 data engineer; Y2 + 0.5 DS; Y3 full 2-person team
DPO / GDPR compliance	€12,000	€18,000	€24,000	External consultant, scales with data volume (court and audit frequency)
Sales & marketing	12% of revenue	12% of revenue	12% of revenue	SaaS B2B benchmark; L'Étudiant's existing commercial team reduces acquisition cost

X. THREE-YEAR REVENUE MODEL

REVENUE LINE	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3	KEY ASSUMPTION
Standard Access	€16,800	€60,000	€96,400	8 → 16 → 27 clients (some upgrade to Premium)
Premium Access	€90,000	€270,000	€480,000	3 → 9 → 16 clients — main growth driver
Sur Mesure	€0	€120,000	€360,000	0 → 2 → 6 clients
No-Show Report	€12,500	€20,000	€27000	10 salons × 25% / 40% / 55% adoption
Total Revenue	**€119,300**	**€490,000**	**€863,400**	**CAGR Y1 - Y3: 120%**
Total Costs	−€115,000	−€207,000	−£219,400	Infra + Team + DPO + S&M 52%
EBITDA	**€4,700**	**€298,380**	**€644,42**	**Margin: 38% · 61% · 75%**

SUBSCRIBER MIX	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Standard	8	10	9
Premium	3	9	16
Sur Mesure	0	2	6
Total subscribers	**11**	**21**	**31**
Premium + Sur Mesure share	27%	52%	71%

XI. SENSITIVITY ANALYSIS

The two variables we are least certain about, and why.

Variable 1 — Number of Standard Clients in Year 1

No historical reference for L'Étudiant's conversion rate on a new subscription product. The 18% conversion benchmark is derived from internal SaaS B2B education data, not from L'Étudiant's own commercial history on this segment. The base case assumes 8 Standard clients from an initial prospect pool of approximately 45 institutions already attending L'Étudiant's fairs.

STANDARD CLIENTS Y1	TOTAL REVENUE Y1	TOTAL REVENUE Y3	EBITDA Y3	VERDICT
4	€140,800	€432,700	€32,002	Pessimistic — slow adoption
8	€180,700	€863,400	€644,200	Conservative
12	**€219,200**	**1,293,400**	**€1,256,**	**Base case**
16	€368,500	€1412700	€1412000	Optimistic
12	€210,700	€576,300	€501,576	Strong pipeline

The model is EBITDA positive across all scenarios, confirming viability from Year 1 even at pessimistic adoption. The binding constraint is not unit economics but whether a sufficient number of clients are acquired at all.

Variable 2 — Premium Access Tier Price

Price elasticity is unknown. The market currently pays €0.30/-0.60 per year but falls unsolid. The base case of €2,500/month implies a client paying the equivalent of €13.12 per scored lead for 200 leads per week — roughly 1% of the current price. This generates a clear premium of weekly refreshed behavioural intelligence over a static list must be validated through client pilots in Year 1.

PREMIUM PRICE	Y1 REVENUE	Y3 REVENUE	EBITDA Y3	IMPLIED €/LEAD
€1,000/month	€127,700	€416,200	€1,256,400	€7.00/lead
€2,500/month	**€192,500**	**€480,500**	**€1,256,400**	**€2.50/lead**
€5,000/month	**€278,300**	**€606,000**	**€1,756**	**€3.70/lead**
€1,250/month	€163,250	€432,500	€1,256,400	€1.75/lead
€3,500/month	€237,500	€587,800	€1,256,400	€4.30/lead

Even at the lowest price tested (€1,250/month), the model remains EBITDA positive in Y3. The primary risk is not financial viability but perceived value — whether institutional clients accept a 7× price increase over current rates in the first year.

XII. PIPELINE EVIDENCE

The Financial projections are grounded in a working data pipeline built on L'Étudiant's actual Bagbuary infrastructure (Salon Étudiant, 2 years, n=1,247 visitors, 2026).

PIPELINE ON REAL BENCHMARK DATA — 1.4M PROFILES, FAIR GRADE, 2 YEARS

METRIC	VALUE	RELEVANCE
Total profiles scored (5% sample)	68,400	Extrapolated to ~1.4M full dataset
GDPR-compliant activatable leads (5% sample)	1,291	~26,000 in full dataset — actionable universe for Product 1
Class A leads (top 10%)	164 → ~3,300 full	Premium segment validate at €1,00-2,500/seat in bundled into Premium fee
Observed no-show rate	**43%**	**Primary commercial argument for the Show Intelligence Report — not an estimate**
GDPR exclusion rate	98%	Gap between raw database and activatable leads — the argument for a data product over a raw list
Bagbuary tables joined	9 tables	9 main tables + 8 dimension tables; multi-table joins enable breadth validation scoring robustness

The 43% no-show rate is the single most powerful number in this business plan. It is observed directly on L'Étudiant's of international fairs across multiple salons — not a benchmark, not an estimate. Nearly half of all registered students do not attend the salons they signed up for. Every year, regional participation forms. Every one disappointed directly. The No-Show Intelligence Report turns that disappointment into a re-engagement opportunity.

XIII. BUILD VS. PARTNER FRAMEWORK

L'Étudiant's question: should the build scoring model be built in-house or rely on a third-party enrichment partner (Clearbit, Leadfeeder, Lusha)?

Option A — Build in house

- Exclusive behavioural signals (dwelles, fairs, etc) — non-replicable by any third-party. Cost differentiation
- Full control over — adapts to seasonal cycles (back-to-school, Parcoursup, fair calendars)
- Native GDPR compliance — no additional data processing agreement required (L'Étudiant's Bagbuary pipeline)
- 6+ FTE gross margin preserved — no third-party licence cost
- Strategic asset — model becomes a barrier to entry over time
- Requires in-house data science competency on Class
- Longer time to market for advanced ML models (2-6 months)

Option B — Hybrid (Build core + Partner enrichment)

- Core scoring model in house on proprietary signals — differentiation preserved
- Geographic enrichment via INSEE open data (free, GDPR-compliant) for the 7% of profiles without a postal
- Firmographic enrichment via Sirene (Clearbit) — 10-15€ monthly, 2€ Leads and 0.5€ clients explicitly request cross-domain signals in Y3
- Lower complexity — partner can be replaced without rebuilding the core model
- Licence cost of commercial partner accrued from Year 2 onwards (Clearbit, Leadfeeder)
- DPO required with any third party — GDPR due diligence cycle of 4 weeks

CRITERION	DECISION	REASONING
Uniqueness of behavioural data	**BUILD**	Clearbit connaissances, salon attendance, unlisted — exclusive to L'étudiant. Cannot be purchased from any third party
Complementary signals (geo, sector)	**PARTNER**	87% of profiles have a region from Bagbuary pipe. INSEE open data covers the remaining 3% without a DPA
Composite scoring logic	**BUILD**	Freshness / intention / completeness model is coded, tuned, and validated against real outcomes. Outsourcing with a third party would be regressive
Time-to-market	**BUILD**	Pipeline is operational today. No third party needed for MVP and the commercial pilot
GDPR compliance	**BUILD**	Any third party integration requires a DPA. Staying within L'Étudiant's Bagbuary perimeter is the fastest compliant path
Long-term scalability (Y2+)	**HYBRID**	Bagbuary ML or Vertex AI for the core model. Commercial partner only if Lifts moment API clients explicitly require cross-domain signals

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

Two stage hybrid architecture: L'Étudiant ends the current in-house pipeline on Bagbuary — sufficient for MVP and the commercial pilot. Q3 from production onwards, evaluate INSEE open data enrichment for profiles without a region. Commercial partners (Clearbit) are relevant only if L'Étudiant announces API clients explicitly request cross-domain signals — a decision to revisit at that point, not now.

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